

Will buses ever be women-friendly?

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[P1] We are alarmed by a new transport survey that says that 63 percent of the women and girls using public transport in Dhaka have to face various forms of harassment, including sexual harassment. According to Farzaba Akter, executive member of Aachol Foundation, while 47 percent of the surveyed complained of being sexually harassed, 61 percent said they were deliberately touched by bus staff while boarding or getting off buses. Some 25 percent of them said they experienced such touches at least three times in the last six months. Equally disturbing, a significant percentage of those who had faced sexual or other forms of harassment in public transport suffered from mental health issues later.

[P2] These findings show that almost nothing has changed in terms of the safety of women and girls in public transport, although the issue has been in discussion for long. The gravity of the situation can be understood from the fact that a number of women were raped and killed inside the buses, too. Sadly, these incidents have not led to significant action on the part of the authorities. Prior to this survey, several other surveys in the past also revealed the toxic male-dominated environment in public transport, where women could hardly raise their voices after being harassed or bullied. Although there has been a practice of keeping seats reserved for women, this is not nearly enough because either the seats are too few for the growing number of women and girls needing public buses, or, as is often the case, these are occupied by male commuters.

[P3] Moreover, reserving a few seats alone will not improve the situation as long as the patriarchal mindset of men remains unchanged. While awareness is needed among male passengers, especially male helpers, to change their mindsets, the existing laws against gender harassment/violence also need to be enforced regularly to hold the perpetrators accountable. Women also need to be given necessary support so that they can file complaints against their harassers. To ensure this, the drivers and helpers, and even police officers, need to be given proper training on gender issues.

[P4] Experts have suggested some specific interventions such as increasing the number of women-only buses, installing CCTV cameras and vehicle-tracking systems in all passenger vehicles, putting nameplates in every one of them mentioning the names of drivers and helpers, and conducting mobile court drives to punish the harassers, etc. It is time the authorities needed these suggestions which, we hope, will help ensure a safe environment for female commuters. (Edited)

1. **What is the central idea of the text?**
 - A. The text concerns the increasing rate of women's harassment in public transport.
 - B. Anam (2022), in his text "Will buses ever be Women-Friendly", talks about the rate of women harassment in public transport and some reasons and solutions to mitigate this issue.
 - C. Anam (2022) highlights recent statistics regarding the harassment of women along with identifying certain reasons behind this issue, such as patriarchal mindset and lack of law enforcement and suggests a few solutions to address this issue.
 - D. Anam (2022) in his text "Will buses ever be Women-Friendly", highlights recent statistics regarding the harassment of women and identifies certain reasons behind this issue, such as the patriarchal mindset and lack of law enforcement and suggests a few solutions to address this issue.
2. **What is the main idea of paragraph 2?**
 - A. Reserved seats alone can not solve the issue.
 - B. Even after taking certain measures, no visible changes are noticed.
 - C. Due to the stereotypical masculinity, even reserved seats are not enough to solve this issue.
 - D. Due to the patriarchal mindset, it is difficult to minimize the severity of women harassment in public transport.
3. **What is the main idea of Paragraph 4?**
 - A. The writer recommends certain ways to increase the security for women in public transports.
 - B. Measures to be taken in order to solve women harassment once and for all.
 - C. Installing CCTV camera and vehicle-tracking systems can solve women harassment.
4. **What is the contextual meaning of the gravity of the situation in the second Paragraph?**
 - A. The severity of the situation
 - B. The severity of women being harassed and murdered in the public transport
 - C. A very serious situation with grave consequences
5. **What is the contextual meaning of toxic male-dominated environment in the second paragraph?**
 - A. Harmful, stereotypical behaviour and belief of men which impedes the growth of women
 - B. Opposite of feminism
 - C. Stereotypical male characteristics
 - D. Men who harass women in public transports have the same mentality.
6. **For the evidence underlined in paragraph 1, the appropriate in-text citation as per APA (7th ed.) would be-**
 - A. Akter, the executive member of Aachol Foundation mentions,, while 47 percent of the surveyed complained of being sexually harassed, 61 percent said they were deliberately touched by bus staff while boarding or getting off buses.
 - B. Akter (2022) points out while 47 percent of the surveyed complained of being sexually harassed, 61 percent said they were deliberately touched by bus staff while boarding or getting off buses.
 - C. Anam (2022) in his article quotes Farzaba Akter, executive member of Aachol Foundation, while 47 percent of the surveyed complained of being sexually harassed, 61 percent said they were deliberately touched by bus staff while boarding or getting off buses.

D. Akter mentions that while 47 percent of the surveyed complained of being sexually harassed, 61 percent said they were deliberately touched by bus staff while boarding or getting off buses (as cited in Anam, 2022).

7. **Which of the following is the correct reference for this text?**

A. Anam, M. (2022). Will buses ever be women-friendly? *The Daily Star*. <https://www.thedailystar.net/>

B. Mahfuz Anam. 2022. Will buses ever be women-friendly?

<https://www.thedailystar.net/>

C. Anam, M.A., (2022). Will buses ever be women-friendly? *The Daily Star*. <https://www.thedailystar.net/>

D. Anam, M. A. (2022). *The Daily Star*. <https://www.thedailystar.net/>